

Brokkur Stonehelm

Class: Artificer
Subclass: Armorer
Homeland: Windford, the City of Vaults
Hobbies: Alchemy

Childhood

To the dwarves of Windford, stone is sacred. They shape it, mine it, and worship its silence. But from the moment Brokkur was born, he did not care for the quiet of stone. He cared for the clack-clack-clack of brass.

His mother, Astrid, often tells the story of how she would lay him down on a soft woolen blanket, only to find him minutes later, crawling with terrifying speed toward the nearest heat-lamp or ticking clockwork surveyor. He didn't play with wooden toys; he played with the gears his father brought home from the deep vaults.

By the age of eight, Brokkur was the terror of the Windford lower districts. If a pneumatic elevator stopped working, or a mechanical oyster-crusher went silent, everyone knew to look for the boy. He would get into trouble constantly—sneaking into locked guild-houses, disassembling expensive steam-valves, and leaving the gears scattered across the floor. He would get yelled at, his ears ringing from his mother's scoldings and the guild-masters' wrath. But when they forced him to put the machines back together, they would find something baffling: the elevator ran smoother, the valves handled twice the pressure, and the oyster-crusher no longer jammed.

He didn't just understand machines. He spoke to them. And they spoke back.

Tragedy

His father, Thrain, was a surveyor for Lord Grizfane Goldentooth, tasked with mapping the deepest, most dangerous vaults carved into Windford's coastal cliffs. Thrain was Brokkur's hero—a quiet dwarf who wore the scent of sea-salt and coal smoke, and who always brought Brokkur strange, broken mechanical scrap from the deep dark.

When Brokkur was twelve, his father took him deep into the vaults to show him the great pneumatic water-gates. It was a routine inspection. But deep beneath the ocean level, a sudden seismic tremor tore through the cliffside. A support beam snapped. A massive stone block crashed down, pinning Thrain's leg to the stone floor.

At the same moment, a high-pressure sea-pipe ruptured. Freezing ocean water began to flood the chamber.

Because Windford's wealth is concentrated in these vaults, Lord Grizfane's security protocols are absolute, cold, and automated: If a breach occurs, the vaults seal and flood to prevent loss of treasure or unauthorized entry.

The massive, mithral-reinforced emergency vault door began its slow, grinding, pneumatic descent. Brokkur, too small and weak to lift the stone off his father, ran to the manual override lever on the wall. He threw his entire weight onto it.

But he was just a child. His muscles weren't developed enough to throw the heavy iron clutch. The gears locked. He screamed, his tiny hands slipping on the cold iron.

His father, water rising to his chest, looked at Brokkur through the narrowing gap of the descending door. "Go, Brokkur! Run!"

Brokkur didn't run. He hammered on the override panel with a wrench, trying to bypass the lock, trying to understand the runes, crying as the freezing water splashed his face. The massive door ground shut with a deafening thud, locking his father inside. Through the thick, reinforced viewing pane, Brokkur watched the chamber fill to the ceiling.

He was entirely helpless. He had all the talent in the world, and it hadn't saved the only man who truly believed in him.

Solution

The grief didn't break Brokkur; it forged him. He swore a solemn oath to his father's memory: No one would ever die because a machine failed, or because he was too weak to reach them.

He stopped building weapons of war. He dedicated his genius to the art of preservation.

- The Aegis Dome: If he'd had a force field, he could have held back the collapsing ceiling and the rushing water. He built a portable, hexagonal projector that hums to life, casting a shimmering barrier of kinetic energy to keep his allies safe.
 - The Stun Grenade: He created flashbangs and electromagnetic disruptors. He realized that violence only causes structural damage—it collapses tunnels and triggers cave-ins. It is far better to disorient and disable a threat instantly, keeping the environment safe for his friends.
 - Biotic Bullets (The Injector-Rifle): He built a custom pneumatic rifle, but it doesn't fire lead. It fires pressurized, alchemical darts. When his allies are wounded or pinned down on the other side of a battlefield—where he cannot physically reach them—he chambers a capsule of glowing, life-saving fluid and shoots them. The needle dissolves instantly, knitting their wounds and surging them with adrenaline. He can heal from a distance, ensuring no one is ever "behind the vault door" again.
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The Current Quest: Seeking the Forge of Heaven

Brokkur has left Windford. He is traveling the world of Abryryim as an adventurer, testing his defensive gadgets in the harshest environments. But his ultimate goal lies back in his homeland.

He wants to return to Windford, bypass Lord Grizfane's "unbreachable" vault defenses, and recover his father's remains. To do that, he needs to build a device capable of withstand the crushing pressure of the flooded vaults. He needs Dark Diamond Ore, and he needs to learn the secrets of the Forge of Heaven to shape it into the ultimate protective suit.

He travels with your group not just as a comrade, but as their guardian angel. He watches over them with a hyper-vigilant, protective eye, constantly tinkering, constantly upgrading, ensuring that this time, everyone comes home alive.

Astrid Stonehelm

Astrid has always been a woman of the sea, even before she met her husband, Thrain. While other young dwarves were obsessed with the heat and glamour of the Forge of Heaven, Astrid was fascinated by the cold pressure and engineering challenges of the 100-mile clam farms. For her entire adult life, she has worked the grids as a Veteran Grid-Overseer, Windford Mariculture Cooperative, supervising the mariculture platforms that suspend millions of pearl-bearing clams just above the seabed.

Astrid's job is a complex mix of industrial agriculture and heavy engineering. Managing 100 miles of lines, anchoring platforms against deep-sea currents, and seeding the mollusks to create rare pearls requires constant vigilance.

Because the most valuable pearls grow in the highest-pressure depths, the work demands heavy **dwarven diving apparatus**. These suits are not simple wetsuits; they are masterpieces of aquatic plate mail—walking, sealed exoskeletons forged from mithral and brass, capable of withstanding the killing crush of the ocean trench.

The Grief: Burying Herself in the Depths

Astrid did not leave her job when Thrain passed. If anything, she became fused with it. When Thrain died, the grief was overwhelming. He died because infrastructure failed him.

Her response was to ensure **nothing ever failed again under her watch**.

Astrid channeled her loss into an aggressive, terrifying standard of safety and perfection. She no longer works a standard shift. She likely holds the record for consecutive "Water-Time" hours.

- **Obsessive Safety Checks:** Where other Grid-Overseers accept 98% efficiency on current-lines, Astrid demands 100%. She will personally dive, sometimes days at a time, checking every anchor, every weld, and every seal. Her grief manifests as an anxiety that only hyper-competence can soothe.
- **The Comfort of the Deep:** Inside her massive diving suit, she is alone. Inside the suit, life is binary: the gauge is either green (safe) or red (danger). She finds peace in the silence of the black water, where the noise of Windford's markets and the pitying looks of her neighbors cannot reach her.

The Legacy: The Source of Brokkur's Armour

Brokkur grew up watching his mother disappear into these suits. For hours at a time, his only connection to her was a silhouette floating in the massive maintenance vats where the suits were serviced, steam rising from the heavy brass plating.

A young Brokkur internalized a critical concept by watching Astrid:

"A dwarf can survive anything—the dark, the cold, the absolute crushing pressure of the universe—if they are encased in a masterfully designed suit."

While his mother utilized these suits to escape the world and manage her grief, Brokkur likely saw them as the ultimate expression of control and protection. When he became an Artificer (perhaps a **Guardian-model Armorer** or an **Artillerist**), his first instinct wasn't to build weapons. He wanted to build *shelter*.

Brokkur didn't just build armor; he built a mobile sanctuary, an exoskeleton inspired by the memory of his steadfast mother, to protect his new "family" (his adventuring team) from ever experiencing the "crush" of loss again.

2 Best Friends

Brokkur found his place in a legendary, rule-breaking trio in the city. Together, they were a rogue research-and-development team, combining raw magic, brilliant engineering, and a fearless test pilot.

- **Vara Ironlung (The First Muse & Brokkur's Crush):** A young dwarf whose job was to swim the freezing, dangerous outer edges of the 100-mile clam farms to pay off a staggering family debt. She put on a brave face, but Brokkur knew she secretly terrified of the crushing darkness of the water. Harboring a massive, tongue-tied crush on her, Brokkur couldn't bear the thought of her in danger. He spent months in his workshop secretly tinkering, eventually gifting her a rudimentary, handheld water-propeller and a custom heat-retaining under-suit. Vara was the first person Brokkur ever built a *protective* device for—and his desperate desire to keep her safe was the very first spark of his Armorer instincts.
- **Kildrak the Scribe (The Arcane Conduit):** A frail, bookish dwarf who served as the apprentice scribe to one of Windford's elite arcane wizards. Kildrak had no stomach for the dirt or physical labor, but his mind was a sponge for magical theory, runes, and planar matrices. He would sneak forbidden grimoires and discarded scroll fragments out of his master's tower for Brokkur to study. In exchange for Brokkur secretly repairing the wizard's delicate, shattered alchemical glassware, Kildrak helped Brokkur translate raw arcane principles into mechanical blueprints. It was through Kildrak's smuggled knowledge that Brokkur learned how to bind magic directly into metal, unlocking the secret to his Artificer infusions.

How They Played:

The dynamic was flawless. Kildrak provided the complex magical equations, Brokkur built the impossible brass-and-iron gadgets, and Vara was the daring pilot who tested Brokkur's early prototypes in the high-pressure depths of the clam farms. They were each other's keepers, and the bond they formed under the city roots shaped the legendary engineer Brokkur would become.